

OpenRail Technical Committee Summary

Report 2026 Q3

The third quarter of 2026 centered on **project onboarding, roadmap reviews, and event preparations** for the OpenRail Technical Committee.

The onboarding of **MscViewer** was completed during the quarter. Following the earlier board vote, the TC worked through the onboarding checklist, resolved license and DCO issues, and migrated the repository. Artem joined the TC meetings and mailing list, and MscViewer will be included in the next metrics report.

The TC received a new project application, **OSCAL4Rail**, which proposes a standardized, machine-readable format for railway regulations. The committee saw no major objections: the underlying NIST-based OSCAL standard is in the public domain and additionally released under CC0, carrying no legal risk. Open questions remained around human oversight for LLM-based regulation checks and the fit of a US standard for OpenRail, so the TC decided to review the recorded community meetup presentation before proceeding. Loïc will check with UIC for related work in the area.

A major theme of the quarter was the **review of project roadmaps**. The TC invited maintainers to present their current plans and identify where OpenRail can support them and where new contributors could join. Reviews covered **RCM OSS**, the **DAC Migration DSS** (including PopUpSim and DACFIT), and **Netzgrafik-Editor**, with projects encouraged to publish roadmap information via the roadmap field in their `publiccode.yml`. Netzgrafik-Editor continued its collaboration with ÖBB and welcomed support toward the next incubation stage. libLRS and OSRD roadmaps were scheduled for the following weeks.

Preparations for **InnoTrans 2026** advanced significantly. OpenRail projects will be presented at the booth, with one project featured each half-day and PopUpSim giving two presentations targeting decision makers and the community respectively. OSRD, SCS, and RailML will also be present, offering opportunities for exchange.

On the community front, the TC confirmed that **Hack4Rail** will return, taking place **23–25 June 2027 in Strasbourg**, coinciding with the 200-year anniversary of railways in Europe. The organizing team, drawing on partners from the other railways, kicks off shortly, and the location near the European Parliament and three political regions offers additional visibility.

The committee also addressed **CI security and performance**, recommending pinned workflow versions with hash references, automated updates via Dependabot or Renovate, and security scanning with tools like Zizmor. A project linter to verify required files and tooling setup was proposed as a valuable side project. For OSRD's CI performance, alternative build providers were explored.

As the TC closes out the quarter, it remains focused on smooth project onboarding, transparent roadmap communication, and the successful presentation of OpenRail at InnoTrans 2026.